

PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · STRUCTURE

authority-chain

Provenance chain — statute to regulation to guidance to case, walked in order.

The chain descends from statute to practice.



branching forks the chain where authority splits.

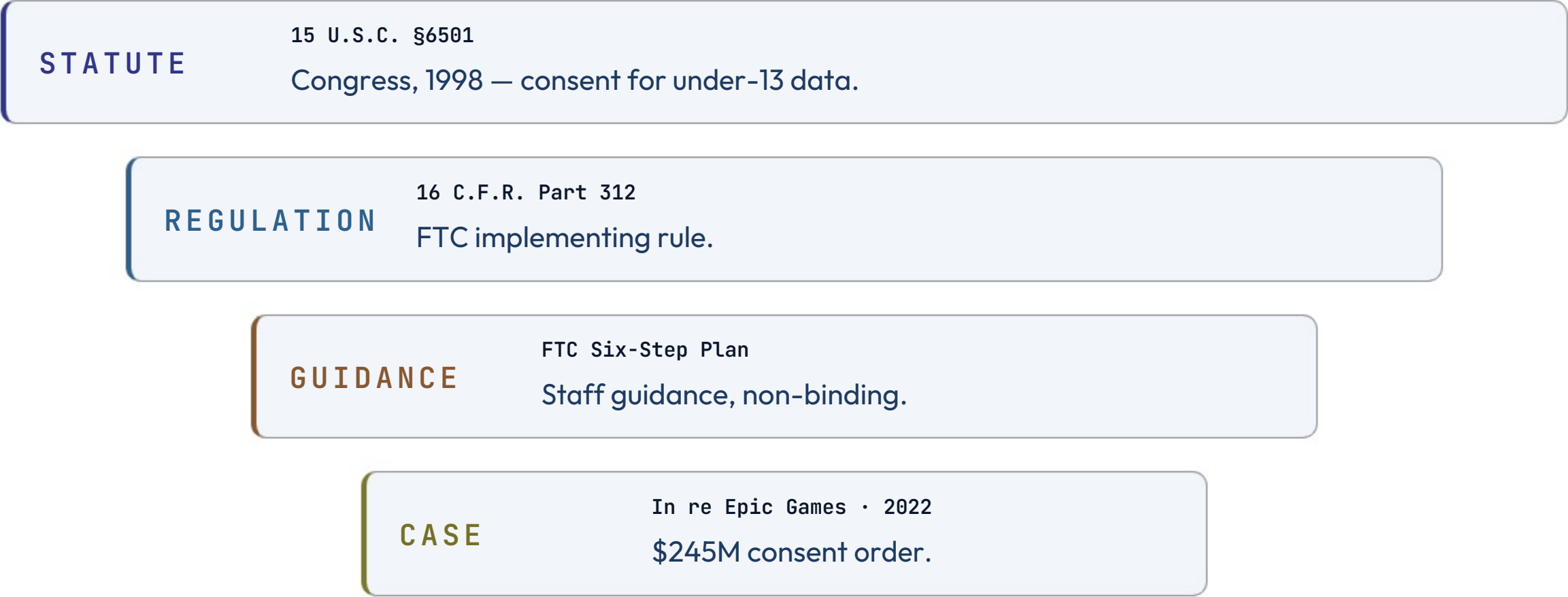
STATUTE

- 15 U.S.C. §6501 COPPA, 1998
- 16 C.F.R. Part 312 FTC implementing rule
- FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan staff guidance
- In re Epic Games · 2022 \$245M consent order
- In re YouTube/Google · 2019 \$170M consent order

trail walks the chain as a breadcrumb.



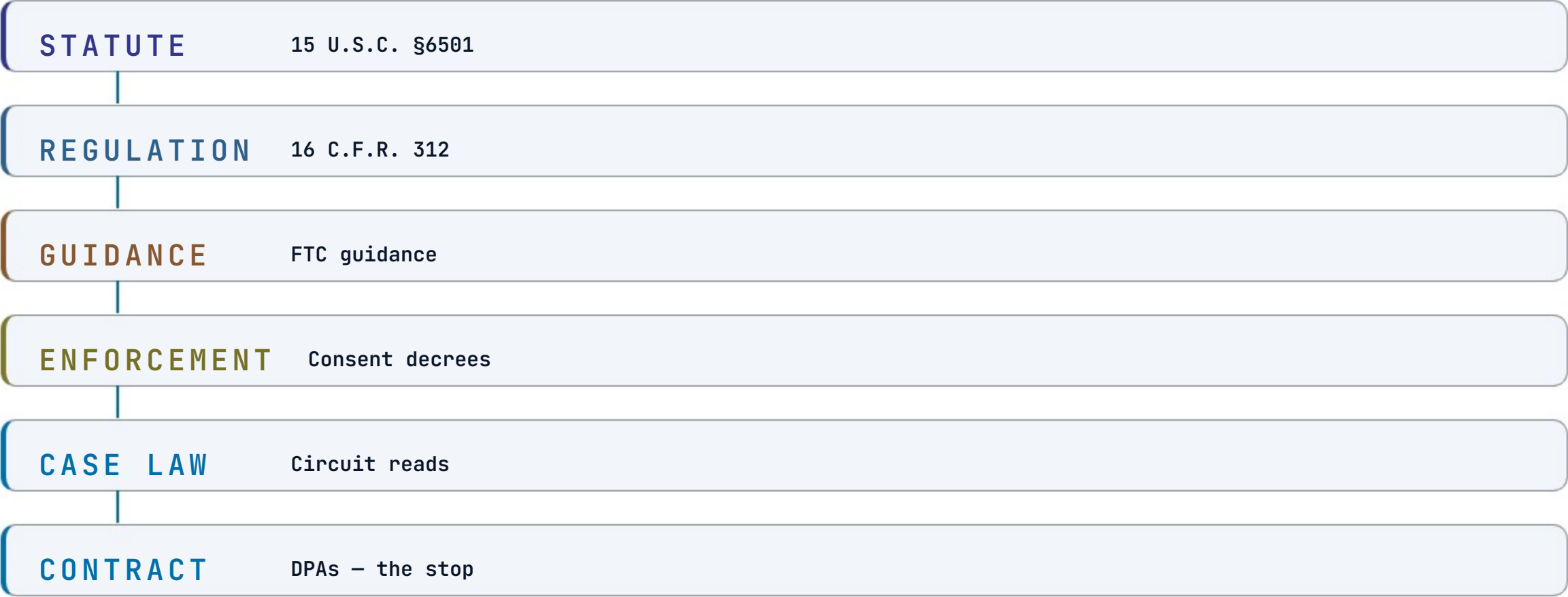
pyramid weights the tiers by force.



bracket groups the tiers by actor.

TREATY	Charter of Fundamental Rights, Art. 8 EU primary law — protection of personal data is a fundamental right.
REGULATION	GDPR (EU) 2016/679 Directly applicable across all member states; sets the Art. 83 fine tiers.
GUIDANCE	EDPB Guidelines 04/2022 Harmonized methodology for calculating administrative fines.
DECISION	DPC v. Meta · 2023 €1.2B fine — the largest GDPR penalty to date.

Six tiers is the chain's ceiling.



The chain descends from statute to practice.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

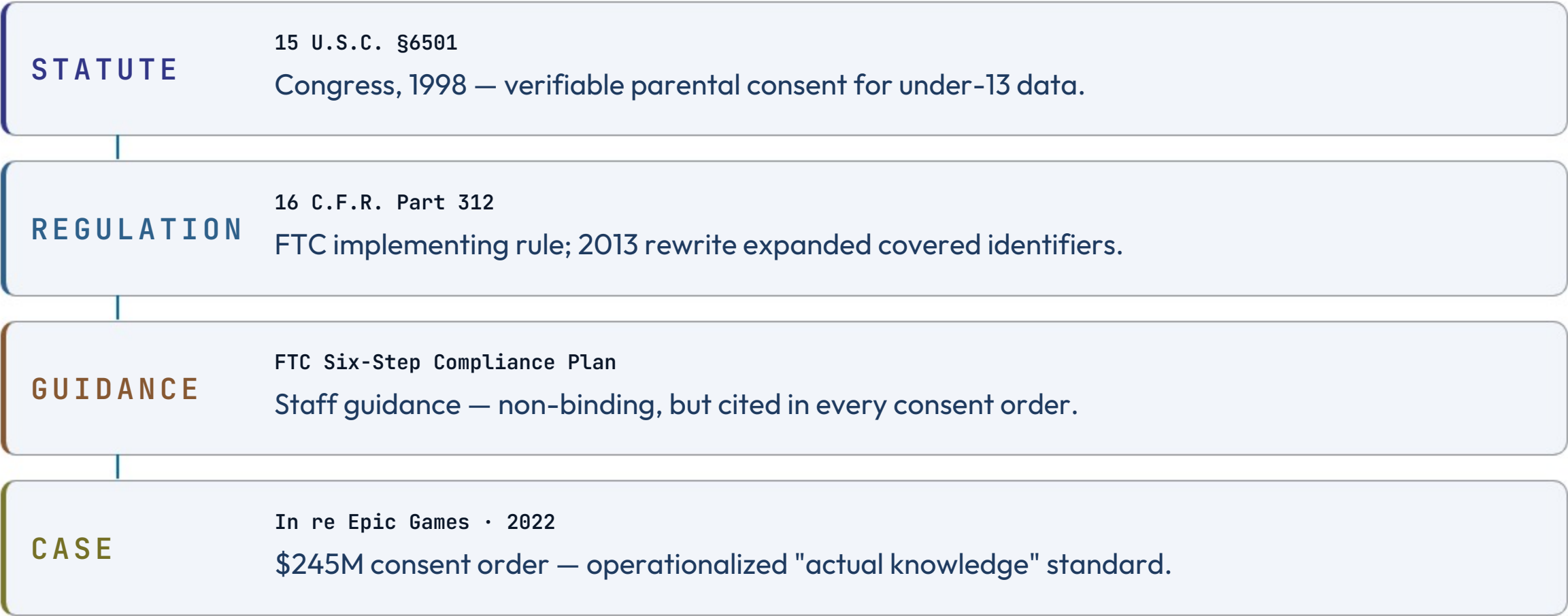
Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalized "actual knowledge" standard.

The chain descends from statute to practice.



The chain descends from statute to practice.



When NOT to reach for authority-chain.

Flat list of citations

If the rows have no tier hierarchy, use `list takeaway numbered` or `regulatory-update`. authority-chain earns its chrome only when the descent from statute to case is the point.

Missing citation chip

The inline-code citation is the row's anchor; without it the gloss reads as opinion. Always cite, even for guidance and case rows.

Out-of-order tiers

The chain reads as a descent: statute first, case last. Reversing it or skipping a tier breaks the metaphor the audience is using to follow you.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`regulatory-update` — period-bounded changelog rather than a single rule's lineage

`list` — `takeaway numbered`: flat enumeration of requirements without tier hierarchy

`list-steps` — the rows are procedural steps rather than authority tiers